

THE THREAT OF DISPLACEMENT:

EVICTON FILING PATTERNS IN CHICAGO

Jared Smith

Capstone Presentation

SUD 502 | Hugh Bartling | Spring 2026

THE THREAT OF EVICTION HARMS TENANTS

Displacing tenants **is a business expense**. Landlords pay legal fees and unit repairs, and they have a vacant unit.

The threat of eviction is cheaper, and sometimes free.

Filings help landlords collect late rent fees, which are considered a **second source of revenue**.

Tenants are less likely to complain, allowing landlords to **save money by deferring maintenance**.

Late rent filings give landlords an excuse to evict tenants **for any reason**.

When tenants are filed against, future landlords are **less likely to rent to them**.

HOUSEHOLD CHARACTERISTICS OF EVICTION

Black renters are overrepresented in eviction filings.

In one national study, Black renters were only **18.6% of all renters** yet were **51.1% of those threatened with eviction**.

Households with children face a high risk of eviction.

One study estimated that, between 2007 – 2016, **children were present in half** of the households that received eviction filings.

Eviction filings are more common in underinvested neighborhoods.

Areas that **gentrified** had **lower eviction filing rates** than areas that did not undergo income or demographic change.

Large buildings owned by corporations file evictions at higher rates.

When investigating eviction in market-rate, multifamily buildings, eviction filings were more likely in properties **with higher assessed values than in those with lower values** within the same census tract.

RESEARCH QUESTIONS

RQ 1: Are there clusters of areas with high and low eviction filing rates in Chicago? If so, what are the differences between demographics, housing costs, and income between them?

RQ 2: What is the relationship between eviction filing rates, households with children, and assessed property values?

DATA SOURCES

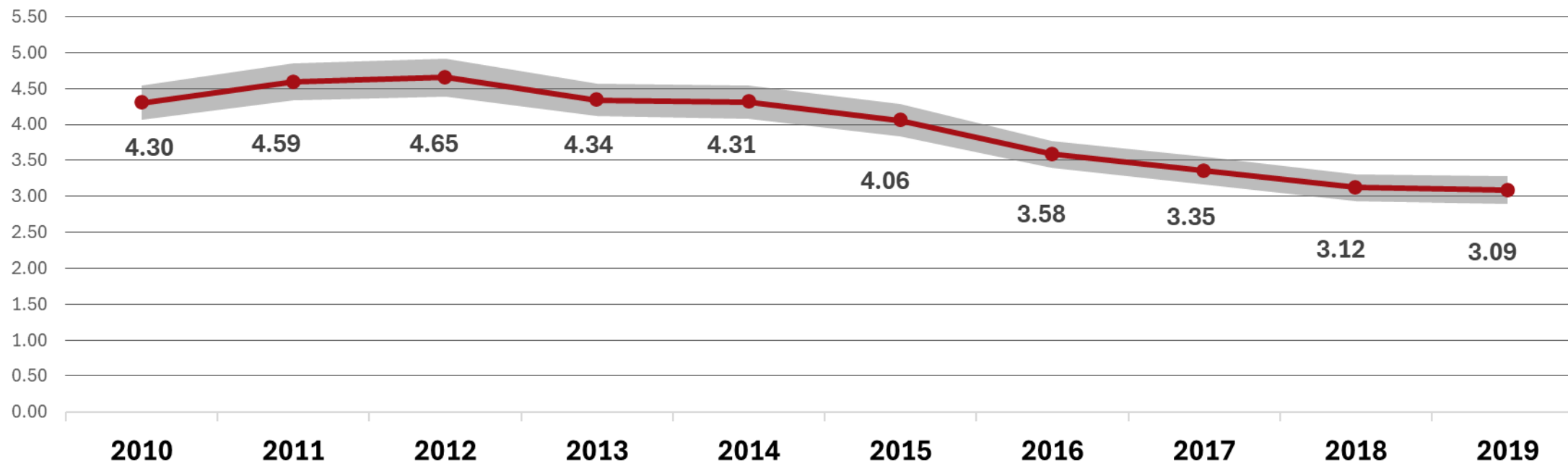
Eviction: *Lawyers' Committee for Better Housing*, contains data on years 2010 - 2019

Demographic, Income, Housing: *American Community Survey*, (2006-2010), (2011-2015), (2015-2019)

Assessed Property Value: *Cook County Assessor's Office Data Portal*, 2010, 2015, 2019

Chicago's **Average Eviction Filing Rate** Decreased Throughout the **2010s**

Grey Area Represents a Range of Possible Rates (95% Confidence Interval)

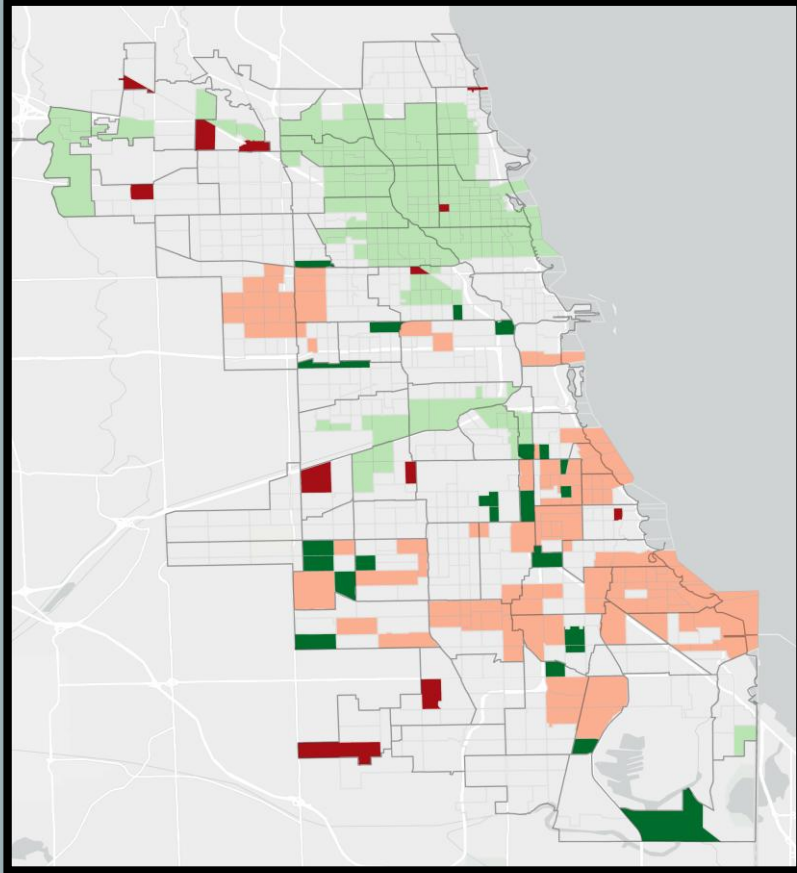


Measures of Central Tendency and Variance by Year

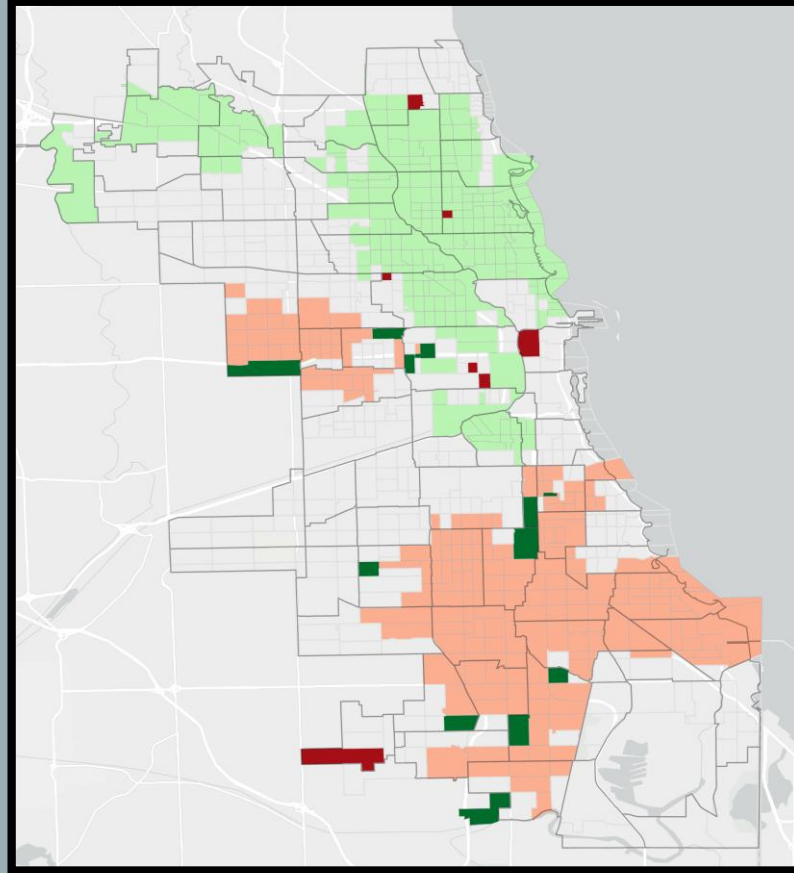
Year	Total Filings	Average Rate	Median Rate	Standard Deviation	Standard Error	Lower 95 CI	Upper 95 CI	Margin of Error
2010	24,390	4.30	3.55	3.46	0.12	4.06	4.54	0.24
2011	25,334	4.59	3.88	3.66	0.13	4.34	4.84	0.25
2012	26,389	4.65	3.94	3.81	0.13	4.39	4.91	0.26
2013	25,201	4.34	3.60	3.33	0.12	4.11	4.57	0.23
2014	24,507	4.31	3.57	3.40	0.12	4.07	4.54	0.24
2015	23,356	4.06	3.19	3.20	0.11	3.83	4.28	0.22
2016	20,439	3.58	2.86	2.77	0.10	3.39	3.77	0.19
2017	19,529	3.35	2.65	2.77	0.10	3.16	3.55	0.19
2018	18,345	3.12	2.18	2.71	0.10	2.94	3.31	0.19
2019	18,220	3.09	2.15	2.79	0.10	2.89	3.28	0.19

n = 804 Census Tracts

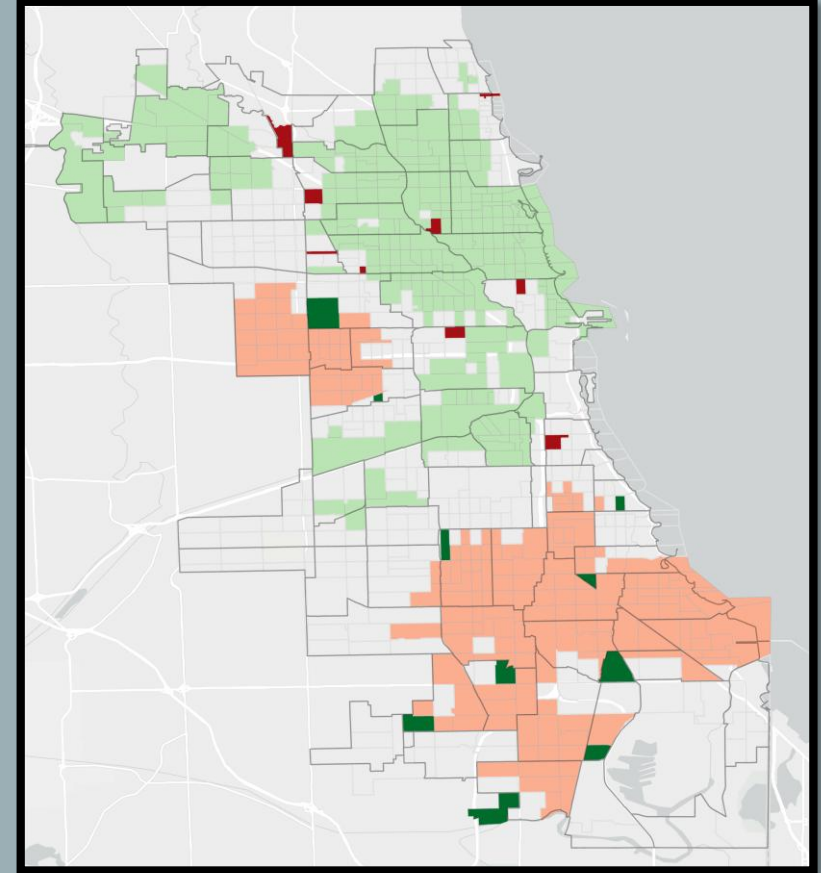
2010



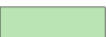
2015



2019



Cluster & Outlier Type

-  High Filing Cluster
-  High Filing Outlier
-  Low Filing Outlier
-  Low Filing Cluster
-  Not Significant



CLUSTERS OF HIGH AND LOW
EVICTION FILING RATES IN CHICAGO

DIFFERENCES BETWEEN EVICTION FILING CLUSTERS

	2010		2015		2019	
	High Eviction	Low Eviction	High Eviction	Low Eviction	High Eviction	Low Eviction
Number of Census Tracts in Sample	103	170	189	207	179	251
Median Value of the Variables						
Eviction Filing Rate	7.01	1.39	7.19	1.15	6.43	0.82
Percent of the Population that is Black	96.10%	2.90%	95.35%	3.24%	94.13%	3.30%
Percentage of the Population that is Latine	1.11%	16.19%	1.81%	14.47%	2.19%	15.24%
Percentage of Households with at Least One Child	37.68%	23.10%	34.74%	21.16%	31.20%	22.85%
Percent of the Population with a Bachelor's Degree or Higher	15.56%	54.57%	12.81%	64.45%	14.86%	62.82%
Percent of the Labor Force that is Unemployed	18.97%	6.43%	25.25%	5.88%	17.79%	3.57%
Percentage of the Housing Stock that is Vacant	19.41%	9.22%	21.66%	8.46%	19.63%	8.19%
Percentage of the Housing Stock that is Owner Occupied	37.09%	43.40%	34.14%	41.22%	32.63%	43.96%
Percentage of the Housing Stock that is Renter Occupied	62.91%	56.60%	65.86%	58.78%	67.37%	56.04%
Assessed Property Value of Census Tract	\$ 13,944	\$ 30,995	\$ 12,334	\$ 30,871	\$ 12,645	\$ 34,933
Household Income	\$ 29,539	\$ 59,188	\$ 26,950	\$ 70,701	\$ 32,237	\$ 80,817
Rent Price	\$ 854	\$ 970	\$ 870	\$ 1,150	\$ 943	\$ 1,313
Rent to Income Ratio	38.8	27.7	40.9	26	39	25.5

2010: n = 797 Census Tracts

2015: n = 798 Census Tracts

2019: n = 798 Census Tracts

DIFFERENCES BETWEEN EVICTION FILING OUTLIERS

	2010		2015		2019	
	High-Low Outlier	Low-High Outlier	High-Low Outlier	Low-High Outlier	High-Low Outlier	Low-High Outlier
Number of Census Tracts in Sample	12	23	7	12	9	10
Median Value of the Variables						
<i>Eviction Filing Rate</i>	5.915	3.19	4.68	3.445	4.22	2.49
<i>Percent of the Population that is Black</i>	2.00%	73.15%	15.20%	80.39%	8.00%	71.48%
<i>Percentage of the Population that is Latine</i>	7.69%	7.37%	8.46%	3.70%	13.89%	5.93%
<i>Percentage of Households with at Least One Child</i>	27.79%	39.15%	23.39%	27.94%	37.75%	25.92%
<i>Percent of the Population with a Bachelor's Degree or Higher</i>	29.92%	12.91%	58.09%	18.55%	42.11%	15.67%
<i>Percent of the Labor Force that is Unemployed</i>	7.48%	15.73%	8.58%	14.94%	6.27%	14.50%
<i>Percentage of the Housing Stock that is Vacant</i>	8.67%	11.55%	8.75%	11.09%	8.14%	17.33%
<i>Percentage of the Housing Stock that is Owner Occupied</i>	71.33%	42.68%	36.36%	42.86%	48.58%	47.85%
<i>Percentage of the Housing Stock that is Renter Occupied</i>	28.67%	57.32%	63.64%	57.14%	51.42%	52.15%
<i>Assessed Property Value of Census Tract</i>	\$ 22,137	\$ 13,365	\$ 21,028	\$ 12,665	\$ 32,129	\$ 13,645
<i>Household Income</i>	\$ 71,479	\$ 35,904	\$ 59,571	\$ 36,692	\$ 53,798	\$ 40,573
<i>Rent Price</i>	\$ 837	\$ 818	\$ 1,211	\$ 903	\$ 1,162	\$ 964
<i>Rent to Income Ratio</i>	27.9	33.7	29.7	37.75	32.4	32.25

2010: n = 797 Census Tracts

2015: n = 798 Census Tracts

2019: n = 798 Census Tracts

2010

<i>Dependent Variable is eviction filing rate (log n)</i>	<i>Coefficient</i>	<i>Percent of Change</i>	<i>Standard Error</i>	<i>Significance Level</i>	<i>P-value</i>
Median Assessed Property Value	-0.038	-3.69%	0.003	***	2.25E-28
Percent of Households with Children	0.485	62.45%	0.189	*	0.0101
Household Income	0.003	0.34%	0.002		0.129
Percent of Housing that is Vacant	0.968	163.14%	0.316	**	0.002
Percent of Housing that is Owner Occupied	0.144	15.49%	0.18		0.425
Rent to Income Ratio	0.007	0.66%	0.003		0.056

*: P<.05, **: P<.01, ***: P<.001

Pseudo R-squ. (CS): 0.3287

Observations = 796 Census Tracts

2015

<i>Dependent Variable is eviction filing rate (log n)</i>	<i>Coefficient</i>	<i>Percent of Change</i>	<i>Standard Error</i>	<i>Significance Level</i>	<i>P-value</i>
Median Assessed Property Value (by \$1,000)	-0.029	-2.82%	0.003	***	3.94E-19
Percent of Households with Children	0.962	161.72%	0.186	***	2.46E-07
Household Income (by \$1,000)	-0.005	-0.53%	0.002	**	0.003
Percent of Housing that is Vacant	1.246	247.50%	0.277	***	6.85E-06
Percent of Housing that is Owner Occupied	0.224	25.16%	0.149		0.132
Rent to Income Ratio	0.015	1.52%	0.003	***	9.37E-06

*: P<.05, **: P<.01, ***: P<.001

Pseudo R-squ. (CS): 0.5526

Observations = 797 Census Tracts

2019

<i>Dependent Variable is eviction filing rate (log n)</i>	<i>Coefficient</i>	<i>Percent of Change</i>	<i>Standard Error</i>	<i>Significance Level</i>	<i>P-value</i>
Median Assessed Property Value (by \$1,000)	-0.031	-3.04%	0.004	***	4.75E-17
Percent of Households with Children	0.651	91.75%	0.26	*	0.012
Household Income (by \$1,000)	-0.002	-0.17%	0.002		0.337
Percent of Housing that is Vacant	2.289	886.9%	0.39	***	4.43E-09
Percent of Housing that is Owner Occupied	0.279	32.17%	0.19		0.141
Rent to Income Ratio	0.014	1.43%	0.004	***	8.68E-04

*: P<.05, **: P<.01, ***: P<.001

Pseudo R-squ. (CS): 0.4305

Observations = 797 Census Tracts

TWEEDIE REGRESSION RESULTS

The Median Assessed Property Value and Percentage of Households with at Least One Child are **both statistically significant, across all three years.**

Reject the null hypothesis that property value and households with children are unrelated to eviction filing rates, while holding income, rent, and housing variables constant.

Property Values have a **negative relationship** with the eviction filing rate.

Households with Children have a **positive relationship** with the eviction filing rate.

CONCLUSION

Neighborhoods with high eviction filing rates have lower incomes, lower property values, and higher rent burdens than neighborhoods with low eviction rates.

The decision to have a child is associated with a higher eviction filing rate.

If evictions are tied to missed rent payments: **why can't tenants pay rent?**